The Bill was referred to a Joint Select Committee consisting of twenty-eight members of both Houses of Parliament in March 1927 and its passage was far from smooth. The Report of the Committee was not unanimous with seventeen of the twenty-five members who signed, appending Minutes of dissent, including Blackett. The Minute of dissent signed by Blackett and six others related to the clauses concerning ownership of the bank and the composition and constitution of the Board.

The Joint Select Committee proposed some important amendments. These were: the bank was to be a 'State' bank with capital being wholly subscribed by the government and not a shareholders' bank; the appointment of an Indian was to be made compulsory i.e. either as the Governor or the Deputy Governor; limitation to be placed on the discount operations and transaction of foreign currencies based on gold; the introduction of a standard gold coin or *mohur* and restoration of the sovereign as legal tender; and provision of six Directors out of fifteen with voting rights to be elected by members of the Central and Provincial Legislatures.[7]

The Joint Select Committee of the Assembly voted energetically under Purshotamdas's persuasion for a state-owned bank. On the other hand, Purshotamdas and his colleagues had opposed the Bill on the ground that the government proposals regarding capital and the directorate of the bank would not take away Whitehall's control over currency. Nor were they convinced that the bank would serve India's interests first before England's needs were addressed. Purshotamdas's opposition to private shareholders had as its basis the fear that placing the responsibility of the directorate of the Board on private shareholders would lead to a situation worse than before where Whitehall and the India Office would be replaced by a 'set of persons completely irresponsible, completely ungettable at.'[8] He feared that non-Indian businessmen and financiers in India would acquire a dominant position.

Speaking in the Legislative Assembly on August 29, 1927, Blackett emphasized that while the Joint Committee opposed a shareholders' bank, it agreed with the government's view that the bank should be completely independent of the government. Blackett, however, questioned 'how the Board of a Bank, the whole of whose capital is subscribed by the Government, can be made entirely independent of it'. According to him,